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Maura Healey



Kate Walsh



Ralph de la Torre

In fall 2023, Healey's administration quickly intervened when Steward Health Care fired a nurse for a fatal lapse in care. The administration thought the firing was unfair. Others considered the move political pressure. The nurse is married to a top state health official.

Broken promises, lax scrutiny Inside the state's failure to regulate Steward Health



This story was reported and written by Chris Serres, Liz Kowalczyk, Elizabeth Koh, and Brendan McCarthy.

Officials softened critical reports, ignored poor conditions and eroding finances, and let the chain close services. Healey says she did what she could within the law.

The phone call to Steward Health Care chief executive Ralph de la Torre from the state's top health official came days after a veteran nurse at Steward's Good Samaritan Medical Center was fired for a devastating lapse — one that a federal investigation later deemed a violation of basic care.

On Sept. 13, 2023, a triage nurse in the Brockton hospital's overwhelmed emergency department received a plea for help from a patient in the registration line. Suffering from acute chest pain and shortness of breath, 37-year-old Jennifer Knight believed she was having a heart attack.

But 10 hours into her nonstop shift, with too few nurses to handle a surge of patients, the

nurse sent Knight back to the line, without evaluating her or checking her vital signs, according to investigators. Knight collapsed just 20 minutes later and died.

That decision, and the tragedy that followed, led to the nurse's termination weeks later, according to hospital records, and prompted an immediate protest from the nurses union.

The response from the Healey administration was also swift. Secretary of Health and Human Services Kate Walsh reached out directly to Steward's CEO. In that call, she didn't focus on the fatal lapse in care. Rather, she had a request.

STEWARD, Page A12



CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF

Donna and Joseph Knight's daughter, Jennifer, died in the registration line at Good Samaritan Medical Center after she told a nurse that she was suffering from chest pain and was having trouble breathing. The Knights are still seeking accountability for her death.

In the century club, and in a league of his own

By Kevin Paul Dupont
GLOBE STAFF

PORTSMOUTH, R.I. — There are only good and better days out here for Arthur Medeiros. He has golfed at Montaup Country Club for more than 40 years, gets around its 18 holes with a familiarity on par with how Einstein navigated $E=mc^2$, and faithfully plays three rounds every week when the weather's right.

"Light rain, he'll play. Temps in the 40s, no snow on the ground, Arthur's on the course," mused Eddie Cabral,

fellow Montaup member and a regular Medeiros playing partner. "He just plays. And don't let his age fool you. He's super, super competitive. All Arthur cares about is playing and playing well."

All the more reason Cabral was caught by surprise one recent autumn day when his old pal surrendered after four holes and retreated to the warmth of the clubhouse. Factoring in the stiff wind off Narragansett Bay, noted Cabral, the real-feel temperature had

GOLFER, Page B5



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Arthur Medeiros, 104, played a round of golf at Montaup Country Club in Portsmouth, R.I., last month.

"That's when I saw Florence Herman. Your body just runs cold."

MEREDITH VASTA, on finding an envelope containing her Chippewa grandmother's hair at Harvard's Peabody Museum

A historical reckoning becomes personal

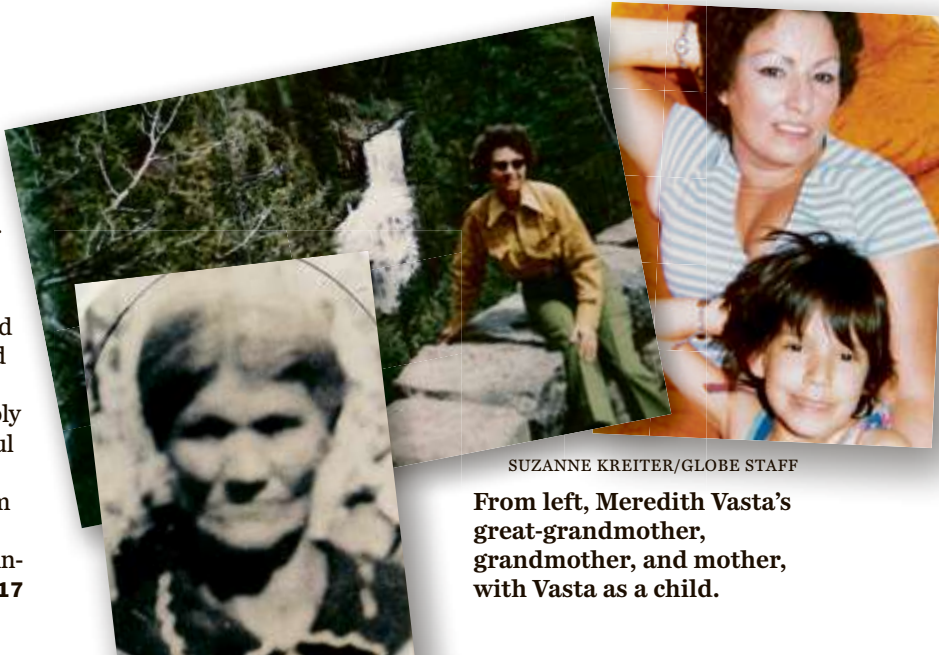
By Malcolm Gay
GLOBE STAFF

Meredith Vasta couldn't bring herself to take the brown hair from the envelope.

It was summer 2022, and Vasta, a collections steward at Harvard's Peabody Museum of Archaeology and Ethnology, had been working for months to organize the Woodbury Collection, a controversial trove of hair clippings from Indigenous people the museum planned to return to Indian tribes.

Native American activists had long accused the Peabody of slow-walking returns of sacred objects and burial remains, a legal requirement. But the Woodbury Collection was doubly combustible: Not only does hair have powerful spiritual significance in Native communities, but the collection also included clippings from around 700 children who'd been forced to attend Indian boarding schools — assimilative in-

VASTA, Page A17



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

From left, Meredith Vasta's great-grandmother, grandmother, and mother, with Vasta as a child.

They thrilled us on the court and won our hearts off it. That is why we're calling the Boston Celtics the Bostonians of the Year. **Globe Magazine.**

Dance, theater, music, more: our look at the best of the arts in 2024. **SundayArts, N1.**

Bill Belichick's new coaching job at UNC is a reminder that he's always going to do things his own way, writes Tara Sullivan. **Sports, C1.**

The US has been in direct contact with rebel group that overthrew Syria's dictatorship. **A6.**

Chill seekers

Sunday: Sun, getting cloudy. High: 33-38. Low: 29-34.

Monday: Clouds and rain. High: 41-46. Low: 38-43.

Complete report, **A24.**
Deaths, **A18-22.**

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